

Tunis Served New Pilot

The choice of Danny Murtaugh to handle the Pittsburgh Pirates will come as welcome news to Scrantonian Angelo "Tiny" Tunis, who served with Murtaugh, in the role of trainer, at New Orleans, for several seasons.

Tunis, a keen Murtaugh admirer, has always expressed profound respect for his fellow Pennsylvanian. Murtaugh hails from Chester.

"He's as good as they have in the Pittsburgh system," Tunis said relative to Murtaugh, and when the former second sacker went to Pittsburgh as a coach with his former New Orleans boss, Joe L. Brown, the scholarly Tunis regarded "the die as cast." Meaning that Murtaugh, circumstances permitting, might one day lead the Pirates.

The close association between Murtaugh and Brown would seem to reject the Pittsburgh opinion that yesterday's appointment is an interim one. Rather it suggests that the peppery chap who once played in the Eastern League will receive a full opportunity.

Tunis, who later worked under Andy Cohen at New Orleans, moved to Indianapolis with Cohen this year. To do so both left the Pirates' family. Even so the Murtaugh elevation could open the major league door to Tunis, who has spent a decade in the minors, awaiting a call to the promised land.